

Daily Bible Note

Date: July 27, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 32:1–16

1 And it came to pass in the twelfth year, in the twelfth month, on the first day of the month, that the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 "Son of man, take up a lamentation for Pharaoh king of Egypt, and say to him: 'You are like a young lion among the nations, and you are like a monster in the seas, bursting forth in your rivers, troubling the waters with your feet, and fouling their rivers.

3 'Thus says the Lord God: "I will therefore spread My net over you with a company of many people, and they will draw you up in My net.

4 Then I will leave you on the land; I will cast you out on the open fields, and cause to settle on you all the birds of the heavens. And with you I will fill the beasts of the whole earth.

5 I will lay your flesh on the mountains, and fill the valleys with your carcass.

6 "I will also water the land with the flow of your blood, even to the mountains; and the riverbeds will be full of you.

7 When I put out your light, I will cover the heavens, and make its stars dark; I will cover the sun with a cloud, and the moon shall not give her light.

8 All the bright lights of the heavens I will make dark over you, and bring darkness upon your land," says the Lord God.

9 'I will also trouble the hearts of many peoples, when I bring your destruction among the nations, into the countries which you have not known.

10 Yes, I will make many peoples astonished at you, and their kings shall be horribly afraid of you when I brandish My sword before them; and they shall tremble every moment, every man for his own life, in the day of your fall.

11 'For thus says the Lord God: "The sword of the king of Babylon shall come upon you.

12 By the swords of the mighty warriors, all of them the most terrible of the nations, I will

cause your multitude to fall. "They shall plunder the pomp of Egypt, and all its multitude shall be destroyed.

13 Also I will destroy all its animals from beside its great waters; the foot of man shall muddy them no more, nor shall the hooves of animals muddy them.

14 Then I will make their waters clear, and make their rivers run like oil," says the Lord God.

15 "When I make the land of Egypt desolate, and the country is destitute of all that once filled it, when I strike all who dwell in it, then they shall know that I am the Lord.

16 "This is the lamentation with which they shall lament her; the daughters of the nations shall lament her; they shall lament for her, for Egypt, and for all her multitude," says the Lord God."

II. Key Summary

- God tells Ezekiel to take up a lamentation for Pharaoh king of Egypt, saying that he was once like a young lion among the nations but is now like a monster in the seas, bursting forth in his rivers, troubling the waters with his feet and fouling them (vv. 1–2).
 - God says He will spread His net over Pharaoh with a company of many people, draw him up and cast him out on the land, cover the heavens and darken the sun, moon, and stars, and bring the sword of the king of Babylon against Egypt's multitude (vv. 3–12).
 - God says He will destroy the animals beside Egypt's great waters so that no foot or hoof will muddy them again; then the waters will run clear and the rivers will flow like oil, and they shall know that He is the Lord (vv. 13–16).
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III. Passage Analysis

The You in Your Head vs. the Real You

"Here we have Pharaoh's regard for himself as a lion, whereas he is no more than a crocodile stirring up mud and filth. So God will haul him out and throw him on land to be eaten by birds and beasts." [1]

In his own mind Pharaoh was "a young lion among the nations," but God's assessment was completely different: a creature thrashing around in the water, leaving everything around him churned up and murky. How you see yourself and what you actually are can be two

very different things.

Muddying the Water Is Never Just Your Own Business

"Fouling their rivers: this refers to how proud and pitiless Egypt, driven by reckless ambition, invaded the surrounding nations and threw the peaceful, settled lives of their people into fear and unrest. From this we learn that a leader must not abuse power to satisfy personal ambition, but should use it to seek the peace and well-being of ordinary people." [2]

The charge against Pharaoh was not that he was strong, but where he aimed that strength — every time he moved, other people's lives got shaken. The question is never how much influence you have; it's whether that influence lands on people as safety or as unrest.

IV. Reflection Question

Is there someone who, just by being there, makes you relax a little? What is it they do that makes you feel that way?

Pharaoh muddied the waters around him and everyone else got unsettled; God pulled him out so the water could run clear — God cares whether people can be at peace where you are.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik's Commentary on Ezekiel 32 (citing Wright), <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-32/>

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Site (ccbiblestudy.org), Bible Intensive Reading Commentary on Ezekiel 32, <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT32.htm>